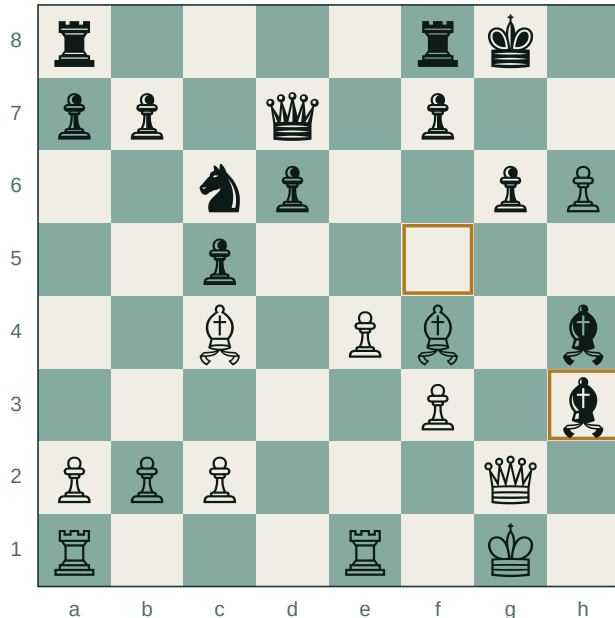


Pins and pressure: White, move 21

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 20...Bxh3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Qxg6+ Kh8 22. Qg7#

21.Qxg6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on g6. Recorded reply: **21...Kh8**.

22.Qg7# Mate: queen on g7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on f7 and pawn on g6.